

Background and Early History

Ahead of The Uncommon Parenting Shift

Your onboarding call is where the real work of this programme actually begins, and this document is part of it, not paperwork to get out of the way beforehand. Taking real time with it means we can use the full two hours to go deep into your specific situation, rather than spending it gathering the background you'll find here instead.

One thing worth saying plainly before you begin. This only genuinely works with real honesty, not a polished or flattering version of things. There's no need for any gloss here, and nothing here to feel guilty or ashamed about, whatever you find yourself writing. An honest picture is what actually makes this useful, a smoothed-over one serves nobody, least of all your own child.

I want to genuinely appreciate you for being willing to do this at all. Openness like this takes real courage, and a genuine willingness to be coached, to look honestly rather than defensively, is worth recognising in itself. Much of the real work ahead isn't about doing more. It's about noticing clearly, often for the first time, what's actually already there.

Context gathered once, ahead of our conversation. Not an assessment, simply useful background. There are no right or wrong answers here.

Whereabouts are you based, city and country?

What time zone are you in, so we can find a time that genuinely works for you?

Household

Everyone living in the home, youngest to oldest, including the child we'll be focusing on.

Age	Sex	Relationship to the child we're focusing on

Are all the children in the household from the same two parents, or is this a blended family, with step-siblings or half-siblings involved?

Circle one: Same two parents / Blended family

Are there other adults regularly involved in your child's day-to-day care, beyond who's listed above, a grandparent, a nanny, a childminder, or similar?

Relationship and Household Situation

What best describes your current relationship situation?

Circle one: Married or partnered, living together / Separated or divorced, shared custody / Separated, one primary home / Parenting alone

If care is currently shared across two households, roughly how is your child's time split between them?

However that's structured, would you say the relationship between your child's parents is generally settled at the moment, or is there real tension your child would likely be picking up on?

Circle one: Generally settled / Some tension / Significant tension

Work and Routine

What's the general work situation in the household? Tick all that apply.

☐ Full-time / ☐ Part-time / ☐ Works from home / ☐ Regular travel away / ☐ Not currently working

On a typical day, roughly what share of your child's waking hours are spent with a parent present, versus another caregiver, nursery, or school?

How predictable is a typical day for your child?

Circle one: Very predictable / Varies a fair amount / Very unpredictable

Recent Changes

A quick yes or no for each, with a brief note if it applies.

Has anyone recently left the family, or has there been a death in the family?

Yes / No, brief note if so: _____

Has anyone recently joined the family, a new partner, a new baby, or similar?

Yes / No, brief note if so: _____

Has there been a recent job loss in the household?

Yes / No, brief note if so: _____

Has there been a significant recent financial change, for better or worse?

Yes / No, brief note if so: _____

How many times has the family moved home during your child's life?

Number of moves: _____

Was your child breastfed, formula fed, or a combination of both? Roughly for how long?

Was a dummy or pacifier used? If so, from roughly what age, and for how long?

What was the sleep situation in the early months, co-sleeping, a separate room, a crib in your room, or something else?

Roughly how much of the day, in the early months, was your child carried or held, compared with being placed down in a pram, cot, or seat?

At what age, and using what approach, was your child potty trained?

Did your child follow the standard vaccination schedule, an alternative or delayed schedule, or no vaccination? This is simply useful context, not something we'll be forming any judgement on.

Which of the following would you say most closely describes your general parenting style? Circle whichever feels closest, or note a mix.

1. Permissive — warm, but with few firm boundaries or consequences
2. Authoritarian — strict rules and high expectations, with limited explanation, “because I said so”
3. Authoritative — warm and responsive, with clear expectations and boundaries that are explained

Thank You

Thank you for taking the time to work through this properly and honestly.

Bring this with you to your onboarding call. We'll go through it together as the first real piece of work in The Uncommon Parenting Shift, not a form to get out of the way beforehand.